regime had become corrupt and was out of touch with the population. Under growing pressure, Ne Win resigned as president, but remained in control over the party. Over the next several years, multiple purges occurred, including a massive shakeup of the military hierarchy.

Ultimately a combination of political and economic unrest set the stage for the evens of 1988. Confidence in the state was at an all-time low and a legitimacy crisis loomed on the horizon. The BSPP had failed to improve the livelihoods of the Burmese citizenry. Any threats from insurgent elements had dissipated as well as external support for any groups opposing the regime. The only group within Burma that saw any improvement in living conditions was the military hierarchy, whose control remained unquestioned by the late 1980s.